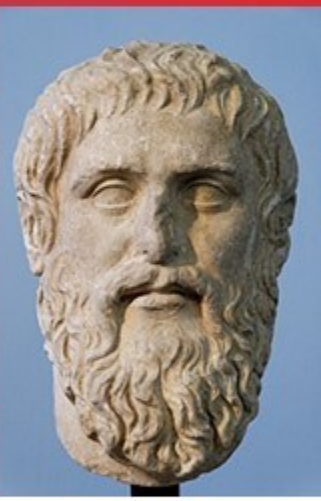
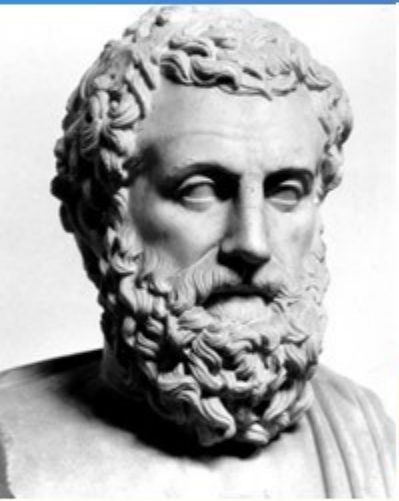


ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE



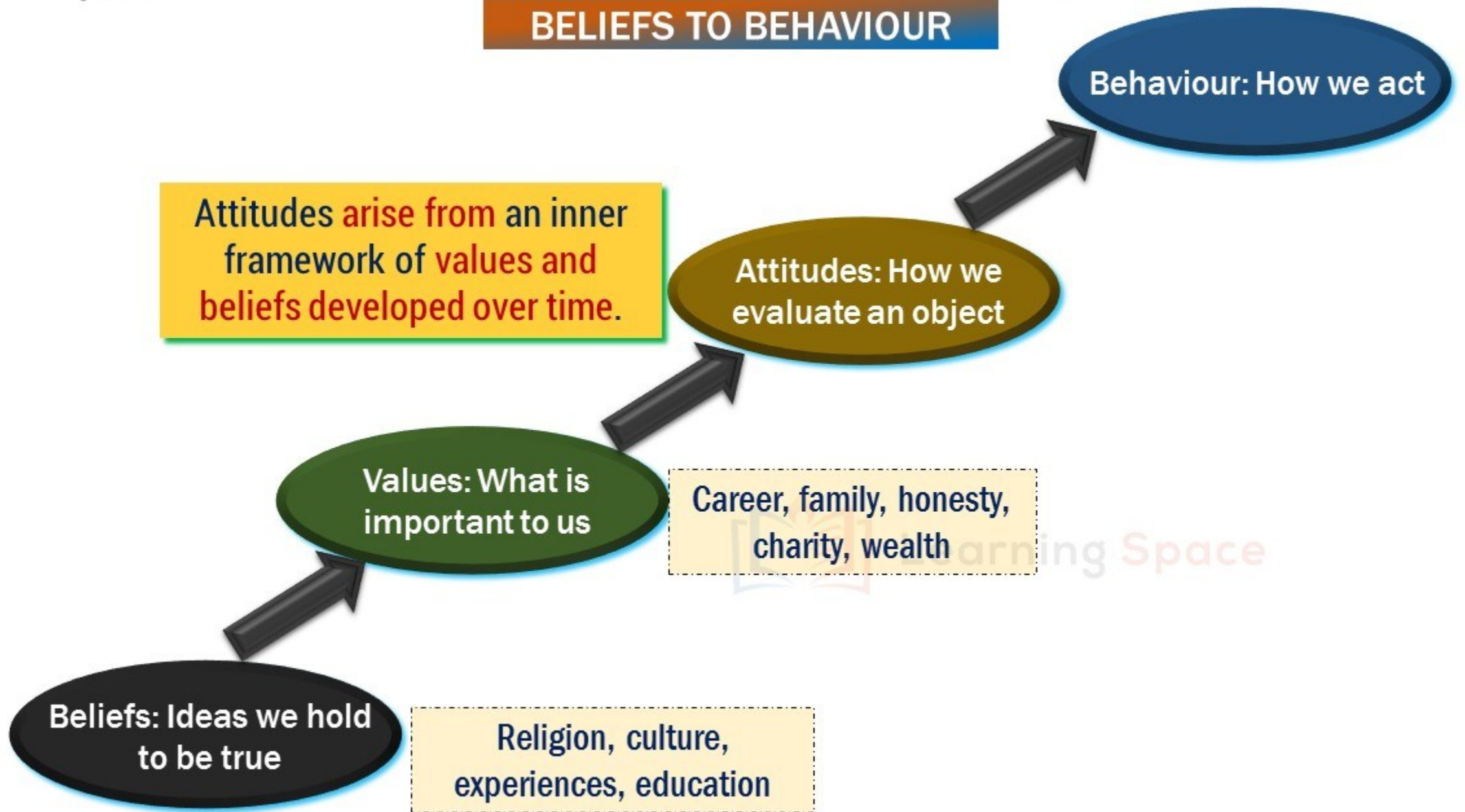
ATTITUDE

MODULE - 16

**INTRODUCTION AND
STRUCTURE**

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

BELIEFS TO BEHAVIOUR



ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

CONSIDER THESE CASES



When Kellogg's entered Indian market, the company claimed that they will **change the food habits of Indians**. But, the tactic was a failure as Indians did not perceive Kellogg's products as substitutes for our traditional breakfast.



Over the decades, Kellogg's changed their goal to **supplement**, not supplant, **our traditional food**, and Indian consumers slowly started to **accept Kellogg's products**.



With the **general elections** round the corner, some people perceive that the ruling party has done enough to deserve another chance, while some others feel exactly the opposite.

Some other voters feel that both the opposition and the ruling party have some merits, and the rest do not have any opinion.

INTRODUCTION



If both of us **like MI**, we have **positive attitude** towards it, and if we **dislike SRH**, we have **negative attitude** towards it.



All of us like some things and dislike others. From the simplest and most ordinary acts to the highly complex and rare ones our species can perform, we are creatures of preferences. In us, preferences exist in distinctly human ways, such as the consciously molded opinions we convey, or the moral codes by which we judge our worth and our failings.

We live in the society and interact with other individuals. We possess knowledge about others. Accordingly we behave with others with certain feeling. Taking all these three – knowledge, feeling and behaviour – a construct is developed, which is termed as 'attitude'.

The study of attitude is one of the core areas of Social Psychology.

INTRODUCTION



“Happiness doesn't depend on any external conditions, it is governed by our mental attitude.”

Attitude is **present** in all individuals and **determines** our **orientation** to other individuals, objects or practices in the society. When we say – “we like someone or something” or “we don't like someone or something” – we **express our attitude towards** individuals, objects, ideas or issues.

Attitude can be **defined** as a **learned**, not an in-born, **tendency** to **evaluate** stimulus/attitude objects in a certain way. The **objects can be** a person or group, place, thing, or an event.

The **evaluations** can be **favourable**, **unfavourable**, or even **mixed or uncertain**.

The stimulus/attitude object is an entity towards which one's attitude is directed.

DEFINITIONS



GORDON ALLPORT



ICEK AJZEN

Campbell (1980) linked attitude with the degree of consistency in a person's response to a situation or subject.

Allport (1935): A mental and neural state of readiness, organized through experience, exerting a directive or dynamic influence upon the individual's response to all objects and situations with which it is related.

Ajzen (1975): A learned predisposition to respond in a consistently favourable or unfavourable manner with respect to a given object.

Hogg & Vaughan, 2005: a relatively enduring organization of beliefs, feelings, and behavioral tendencies towards socially significant objects, groups, events or symbols.

DEFINITIONS



Carl Jung : readiness of the psyche to act or react in a certain way.

He said attitudes occur in pairs out of which one is conscious and another unconscious.

He identified the following pairs of attitudes

CONSCIOUS	UNCONSCIOUS
Extraversion	Introversion
Rational	Irrational
Individual	Social
Abstract	Creative

The most widely used definition is given by **Eagly and Chaiken (1993)** who define an attitude as 'a psychological tendency that is expressed by evaluating a particular entity with some degree of favour or disfavour'.

Reporting an attitude involves making a decision concerning liking vs. disliking, approving vs. disapproving or favouring vs. disfavoursing a particular issue, thing, place, or person.

An attitude can vary in two important ways. First, in **valence**, or **direction**. Some attitudes that a person possesses are **positive**, others are **negative**, and yet others are **neutral**. Attitudes can be **mixed** and can **change** from time to time.



ABSTRACT



CONCRETE



ONE'SSELF



OTHERS



POLICY ISSUE

Second, attitudes can differ in **strength**. For **example**, while one person might feel very strongly about Pakistan's support to terrorism, a second person might feel much less strongly about the same topic.

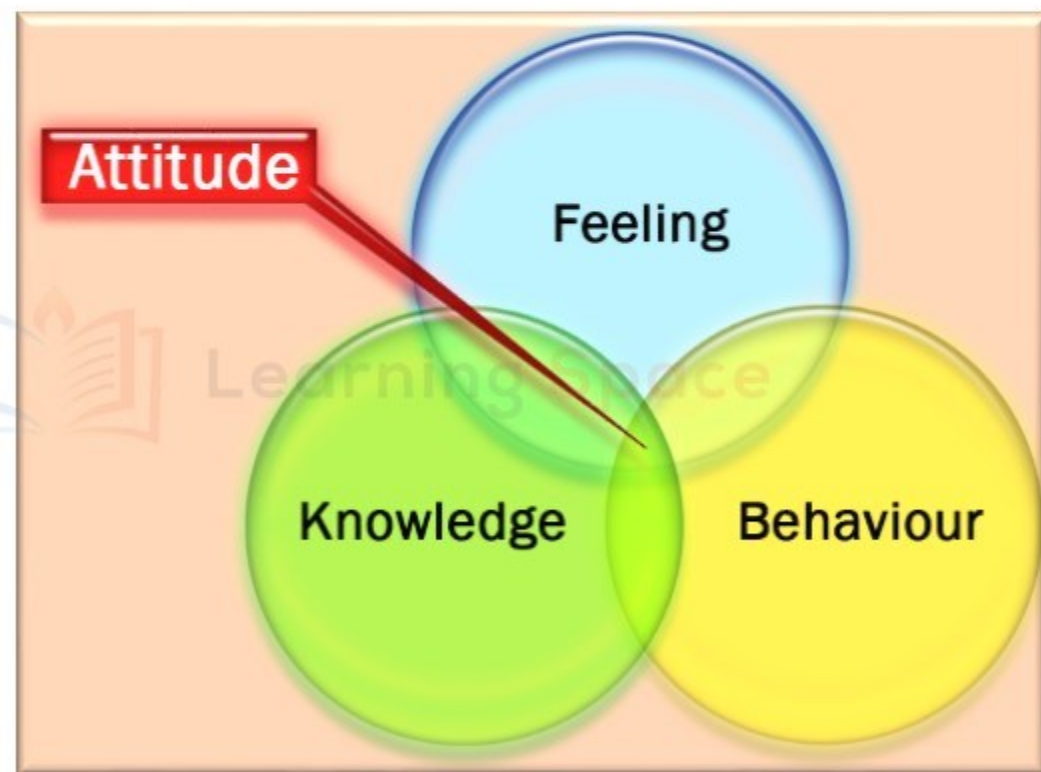
Basically, any stimulus that can be evaluated along a dimension of favourability can be conceptualized as an **stimulus or attitude object**.

Some stimulus/attitude objects are **abstract** concepts, others are **concrete**. Furthermore, one's **own self** and other **individuals** can serve as attitude objects, as can **social policy issues** and **social groups**.

STRUCTURE OF ATTITUDE

One of the most influential models of attitude has been the multicomponent model known as **CAB** or **ACB** model. According to this perspective, attitudes are summary evaluations of an object that have **affective**, **cognitive** and **behavioural** components.

Some views of attitude structure see the cognitive and behavioural components as derivative of affect or affect and behaviour as derivative of underlying beliefs (Fazio, 2003).



Cognitive component of attitude: thoughts, beliefs and attributes associated with an attitude object.



The **cognitive component** is made up of the **beliefs** of an individual about the object (other individuals, objects, ideas or issues) of the attitude.

Beliefs are pieces of information available about the object towards which attitude forms. Beliefs **play a vital role** in explaining things to others. We **hold beliefs about** our religion, our family and about several other objects.

In many cases, a person's **attitude might be based primarily upon** a consideration of the **positive** and **negative attributes** about the attitude object.

Affective component of attitude: the feelings or emotions associated with an attitude object.



The affective component of attitudes **refers to feelings or emotions** associated with an attitude object.

A primary way in which feelings affect attitudes is **due to affective reactions** that are aroused in the individual after exposure to the attitude object.

For instance, many people indicate that cockroaches/lizards make them feel scared. These negative affective responses are likely to produce a negative attitude towards cockroaches/lizards.

Attitudes about emotional issues such as **religion** and **politics** are usually shaped by affective component of attitude.

Behavioural component of attitude: past behaviours associated with an attitude object.



Self-perception theory assumes that individuals often do not know their own attitudes and, like outside observers, have to engage in attributional reasoning to infer their attitudes from their own behaviour.

The behavioural component of attitudes **refers to past behaviours** with respect to an attitude object.

The behavioral component **consists of a predisposition or tendency** to respond in a certain way to the object of the attitude. If one possesses a positive attitude about someone, his or her actual behaviour would be favourable and vice versa. Generally **behavior** has been **used to describe overt actions and responses** to the attitude object.

Behaviours may also **influence strongly held attitudes**, and can influence attitudes **in a direct way**.

ARE THEY SAME?



Whilst in the presence of a real snake, participants of an experiment indicated whether (i) snakes are kind and cruel (cognition), (ii) snakes make them feel anxious and happy (affect), and (iii) they like to handle snakes (behavior).



The CAB components are **not essentially same**: The cognitive, affective, and behavioral scores of the experiment were only moderately correlated with each other. Thus, these components were proven to be empirically distinct.

But, they are **not completely independent from each other**: the positive cognitions, affects, and behaviors **all contribute to one's positive attitude** toward an object. For example, if one likes Amitabh Bachchan's movies, it could be because of the entertainment of the movie, the happiness generated from watching the movie or the habit of watching his movies.

ARE THEY SAME?



Blood donation saves lives:
Cognitive



Afraid of blood donation:
Affective



Past bad experience:
Behavioural

CAB components don't always have the same evaluative implications: For example, someone may say that blood donation is a noble endeavor, implying that he has positive cognitions. However, he may admit that it makes him feel afraid. He would also recall the negative experience of having once been jabbed repeatedly by a sadistic nurse who was unable to locate a vein in his arm. Thus, his cognitive, affective, and behavioural responses about blood donation *differ in valence*.

While the cognitive, affective, and behavioral components are (usually) consistent in their evaluative implications, they are not simply different ways of saying the same thing.

CHARACTERISTICS



Attitudes are learned: Attitudes are **not instinctive, rather learned**. An individual's attitudes are based on their past experience, exposure and knowledge about the attitude objects.

Attitudes are relatively stable: Once the individual develops an attitude, the information opposing to it is not attended easily by the individual. As a result the individual is not easily affected by the opposite information and **holds the same attitude for a relatively long period**.

Attitudes are dispositional: Attitudes **are basically internal disposition**. These are the characteristics of an individual which differ in their strength from one another depending on the process of socialization of the individual.

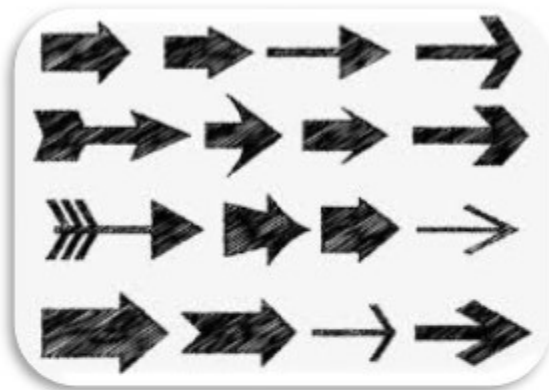
CHARACTERISTICS



Attitude possesses dimensions: An individual either likes an object or dislike it. Thus, very often the range of attitude varies from strongly positive to strongly negative. Sometimes attitudes are also ambivalent, both positive and negative feelings toward an object.

Attitude helps establish our identity: Each individual possesses attitude which is a complex and unique integration of knowledge, feeling and behaviour in a different way with a different intensity.

Attitude influences behaviour and vice versa: The relationship between attitude and behaviour can be influenced by factors including qualities of the behavior, person, situation in which the behavior is exhibited, and the attitude itself.



ASPECTS OF IMPLICIT ATTITUDE

Source awareness: people's awareness of the origin of a particular attitude.

Content awareness: people's awareness of the attitude itself, rather than simply its origin.

Impact awareness: the influence this attitude has on other psychological processes.

Attitude influences and guides our thought: Attitude can be implicit or explicit. **Implicit** attitudes are those which are uncontrollable and potentially not consciously accessible. **Explicit** attitudes are conscious and easy to report.

Implicit attitudes are introspectively unidentified or inaccurately identified traces of past experience that mediate favorable or unfavorable feeling, thought, or action toward social objects.

Gawronski, Hofmann, and Wilbur (2006) have proposed **three aspects of implicit attitudes** which are measured through current indirect measures. These are source **awareness**, **content awareness**, and **impact awareness**.

“The only disability in life is a bad attitude.”

“Your attitude, not aptitude, that determines your altitude.”

“Leadership is practiced not so much in words as in attitude and in actions.”

Attitudes possess structure: Researchers have identified two general types of attitude structure, such as **intra-attitudinal structure** and **inter-attitudinal structure**. Intra-attitudinal structure refers to the **structure of a single attitude**, whereas **inter-attitudinal structure** refers to structures **involving more than one attitude** (also referred to as attitude systems or sometimes belief systems). Generally, **intra-attitudinal** is used **when a single object** is considered and **inter-attitudinal**, **when two or more objects** are involved.

Attitudes serve motivational functions: Attitudes serve primarily four motivational functions, such as **ego-defense**, **value-expressive**, **instrumental** and **knowledge functions**.

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